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Infinite-Mud3931

Britain’s food supply is precarious – and Trump’s chaos is spreading. I have a plan. Do you? | George Monbiot

Even Monbiot's getting prepping!

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Hungry-Editor6066 • 2mo ago

But, one of the key points of the article is bang on - we should be doing this as a community. I have lots of elderly neighbours, who are on state pensions. They can't afford to stockpile two months worth of food. If, and I hope it doesn't come to it, there is another massive shortage of commodities like food; how can I possibly sit my family round a table with a full hot meal, whilst knowing my neighbours may well be suffering or even starving?

The flipside of this, of course, is that if I were to open up meals, share food, etc I'd not only suddenly find myself turned into a food bank of sorts, but I'd be a potential target for violent crime to "relieve me" of my stockpile, or in the most basic circumstance, need to stockpile beyond what my family needs so I can help others even a little.

This then becomes a moral question... is it my personal responsibility to feed others? No. But, is it the moral thing to do, and the civic (patriotic for the Americans reading) thing to do? Yes. But grey man theory says I should not gnome the morals, not expose myself or my resources, and look after my own. I guess it's a personal moral struggle.

33 Reply ···

Long-Time-lurker-1 • 2mo ago

Thankful i found this Sub, the general prep sub seems to be quite Americanised and geared towards shooting everyone in sight. The only way our species can continue is by working as groups not individually. We have to all group together and work ourselves out of a problem. To stockpile massive resources and guard them is an immediate solution to short term survival. However in the long term we rely on each other. I would optimistically hope the UK would dig out the old Blitz spirit and work together in crisis. In reality im not 100% sure anymore, but i hope.

20 Reply ···

thirdtoebean • 2mo ago

Yeah, prepping discourse is very often hyper-individualist, but really, we do better in groups of (pro-social) individuals. The 'one self-reliant man surveying a post-apoc landscape' image is romantic but I think teamwork is much more reliable. He can't stay awake 24/7 to defend his stash. Also, as you say, what are you surviving *for* if you abandon the moral principles that make this whole thing worth it.

Plus, granny next door lived through wartime rationing; she might be poor but she's going to have frugality/make-do-and-mend skills like you wouldn't believe.

15 Reply ···

gominokouhai • 2mo ago

That's a little outdated. A woman who was twenty years old when rationing ended in 1956 would now be 91, and I doubt she has the same skills with a needle and thread.

Granny next door, unless you happen to live next to a care home, probably grew up in the 60s or 70s.

4 Reply ···

1 General Survival Guidelines

In the event of a worldwide catastrophe, emergency services will be stretched beyond their limit. There are simply not enough resources to look after everyone.

Do not expect rescue.

Any stockpiles the authorities may have will be depleted quickly, and more than likely will be distributed between greedy powers before you get a look in.

It is up to YOU to ensure the survival of you and your loved ones.

1.1 PLANNING YOUR SURVIVAL

In your survival strategy, do not make huge plans. Large operations are likely to be noticeable to others and there will be many who will not take steps for their own survival. Do not advertise your plans and limit your group to people you know – family and friends. Even if you don't get along with certain family members, at least you will be with people you know.

1.1.1 CHOICE OF LOCATION

Whether you have a remote property, plan to purchase one or to simply bug out at the last minute, research your location well. First choose a location that is far away from large city centres. When broad disaster strikes, people wander - even when they don't know where they are wandering to. City centres will be death traps and citizens will pour from them in large numbers. There will be a lot of starvation, desperation, confusion and fear. A stampede of scared, hungry people through your community will not do anyone any good.

A rule of thumb is to be 150 km (100 mi) from coastlines or more. Tsunamis can wash water over huge areas of land in a very short time. The power of moving water is immense and easy to underestimate, even when it is not very deep. Choose high ground, at least 20 m (60 ft) higher than the average surrounding level. Rivers can swell and floodplains will flood.

As well as being higher than the surrounding area, you should be about 200 m (600 ft) above sea level. This is the estimated rise in sea levels if the polar caps should melt.

Weather patterns as they stand today cannot be relied upon – even now the weather is changing quicker than experts can predict. Therefore you should consider the possibility of near constant downpour or drizzle in your area. Constant rainfall can liquefy soil, filling the air pockets with water and turning it into a type of quicksand. Coupled with jiggling, rumbling earthquakes, a solid bunker can sink completely into saturated soil, with you in it. The underlying ground should therefore be solid bedrock, and of course, not near a fault line.

1.1.2 TRAVELLING

When you need to travel it is best to keep a low profile. If you have a working vehicle and road travel is still possible, take the back roads. If asked, do not announce your plans or destination – say you are on a 'camping trip' or 'visiting relatives'. If you are on foot, you can follow a main road without travelling on the road itself. Keep yourself well hidden at a distance of 20-100 metres or so, depending on the cover available.

Avoid large gatherings of people. If you are well stocked with equipment and food, there will be people who feel they deserve your gear more than you do, and will not be kind about it.

1.2 THE MAN

Authorities should generally be avoided. This includes government, military and law enforcement. When panic hits, the structure and rules of society will no longer apply and you cannot assume the protectors will protect you. Members of the establishment are people too and will be just as scared and confused as everyone else, except they will probably be better armed and more trained than you. Even if you are well armed and proficient with firearms, the last thing you and your family need is a gunfight.

In the confusion and panic, military units may turn rogue, with no fear of the consequences. Remember, those in authority with a heart will most likely be AWOL looking after their families, not roaming in armed gangs. Do not approach these groups. Signalling techniques will NOT be discussed in this guide. Keep your head down.

1.2.1 SURVIVOR CAMPS

You may come across survivor camps set up by the government or military. These camps will operate under the pretence that you will work in exchange for food, shelter and medical care. Depending on your country, government and the individuals running the camp, they will range from genuine humanitarian operations to full blown slave camps.

Your possessions will be confiscated and distributed. You may not be allowed to leave and if you do manage to escape it will be by the skin of your teeth with little to no equipment. Conditions will degrade quickly as stores are depleted without incoming replacements. You cannot assume those running the camp will be fair. Such a situation can easily lead to cannibalism. Do NOT approach any official-looking camp setups. Approach ANY camp carefully.

1.3 FOOD

Do not rely on a **large** hoard of goods. Depending on your location and local government, martial law may be declared. One of the first things that will happen in such a situation is that useful civilian goods will be seized and redistributed, rendering your stockpiling efforts useless.

Neighbours may notice you buying unusually large amounts of goods ahead of time and will remember when they are starving. If you are raided by looters, packaged dry goods are easy to take and you will be left with nothing. Your 'friends' will raid you wearing balaclavas.

It is advisable to start a garden and raise small animals such as poultry and rabbits now. Such a setup is not suspicious and will keep producing when well tended. It will be far better for you than highly salted survival food anyway. It will be difficult and time consuming for thieves to harvest and it is unlikely that they will clean you out. Deploy mantraps at your own discretion.

If you are not in a position to start farming you will need to know how to live off the new landscape. Traps and snares for animals and fish are effective, quiet and relatively easy to set up. Many wild plants can be eaten but care must be taken with identification.

Do not be scared to eat small critters like bugs and worms. These are highly nutritious and even favourable in many countries. They are also abundant in most places.

1.3.1 SEEDS

Seeds should be stored in areas that are cool, dark and dry. Some seeds last longer than others but should be viable for at least three months or more. Study and practice sustainable 'seed to seed' gardening now – I can't include a complete guide in this small tome. Take special note of seed saving and storage.

Keep a varied stock of many types of seeds. You can't assume your climate will remain unchanged – in fact, you can pretty much guarantee it won't – and you may be surprised at what plants will grow. If you are having trouble cultivating certain types of plant then wait until the weather changes otherwise you may burn through your entire seed stock.

Seeds can be eaten raw but this is not advised. Commercial seeds are guaranteed to germinate via hormones and chemicals. Good for plants, not so good for humans. Some seeds are naturally poisonous and this can vary between seasons. Seeds that may be good to eat in spring may be lethal in winter. Unless you are an expert, or a gambler, DO NOT EAT SEEDS. Once they are gone you have little to zero chance of getting them back.

1.4 WATER

Water is one of the most important survival needs. You will need an endless supply of clean water for drinking, cooking and personal hygiene. VERY serious short and long term problems will arise if you are not painstakingly careful about your water supply.

1.4.1 CONTAMINATION OF TRADITIONAL WATER SOURCES

If you are near a flowing river or in an area of constant rainfall you may think you have all the water you need. However, chemical spills, acid rain, volcanic ash, changes in rainfall patterns and many other factors can affect the quality of water. Commercial water filters can remove bacteria (0.22 micron pore size) and even viruses (0.02 micron pore size) but may not remove dangerous chemicals or heavy metals. Rain and groundwater can be contaminated yet be completely clear and tasteless.

Clean water can be collected from condensation from cold surfaces, morning dew, or from plants but these methods take a long time to yield a small amount of water.